- Build up the climax gradually.
- Introduce dialogues that are interesting, lively, relevant and natural to the context, wherever possible.
- Handle the conclusion of the story well. The story should have a striking end or a dramatic twist. It may also end with a moral or a message.
- Provide an appropriate and a catchy title. The title may be based on the incident of the story or the chief character (protagonist). The story may also be titled after a proverb or a familiar quotation illustrated by the story or a popular catch phrase.
- Revise and edit your writing as many times as possible till you feel it's perfect.
- Show, don't tell. (Instead of saying "The boy was happy" say "The boy whistled as he walked down the corridor."

❖ When you write a story, remember to use…

- the simple past tense, the past continuous tense and the past perfect tense
- suitable adjectives and adverbs
- direct speech with reporting verbs and proper punctuation marks
- linkers and discourse markers

To begin with, one can train oneself to write stories by following two steps:

(i) expanding the given outlines into a story

(ii) completing a partly narrated story.

Task 1

Expand the following outlines into complete stories and supply a suitable title for each.

Here is an example.

Outline:

A wealthy old lady – suddenly loses eyesight – calls an eye specialist – doctor demands exorbitant fees – lady agrees to pay if cured – doctor starts treatment – steals antique decorative pieces -one by one – treatment ends - lady's vision restored – doctor demands fees – lady refuses to pay – doctor knocks the doors of court – seeks justice – judge enquires lady – lady explains – not completely cured – cannot see antique items – kept in showcase – judge understands – gives verdict – lady's favour – arrests doctor for cheating.

Story

The Invisible Antiques

In a grand old-fashioned mansion overlooking a hill, lived a wealthy dear old lady named Margaret J. Smith. She inherited a huge fortune from her late husband John Maxwell Smith. Being a very smart and shrewd woman, she ably managed her estate all alone. As she grew older and older, she became frail. Subsequently, her eyesight also started failing. One day, when she woke up from her bed, she realised that she had lost her sight.

The old lady immediately sent word to an eye-specialist in the County to treat her. The doctor though skilful in his profession was a greedy and crafty person by nature. He visited Margaret Smith the very same day and examined her. He told her that he

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